

UNA-USA MUN Rules of Procedure

A detailed committee-running guide from attendance and quorum to debate, documents, chits, and voting

Important status note

This is not an official UNA-USA publication. It is a practical, conference-ready guide to common UNA-USA-style Model UN procedure. UNA-USA-style rules vary by conference, committee, and region. Always follow the rulebook issued by your Secretary-General, Director, or Executive Board.

Use this as a teaching manual, delegate handbook, chairing checklist, and quick-reference procedural map.

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Best way to use this document

For a first-time delegate, read Sections 2, 4, 6, 8, 9, 10, 11, 13, 14, 16, and 17 first. For an Executive Board member, start with Sections 3, 4, 9, 12, 16, 18, and 20.

1. How UNA-USA-style procedure works

UNA-USA-style Model United Nations procedure is a structured debate system. It gives delegates a predictable path for moving from speeches to negotiations, from negotiations to written proposals, and from written proposals to voting. It is not meant to be a maze. It is meant to stop chaos from taking over the room.

In practice, the procedure balances three needs: fairness, efficiency, and diplomacy. Fairness means every delegation has the same procedural rights. Efficiency means the committee can eventually reach decisions. Diplomacy means delegates must persuade, negotiate, and write solutions instead of simply attacking one another.

Key principle

Procedure is the steering wheel, not the destination. A strong delegate uses procedure to create space for substance: speeches, policy, bloc-building, drafting, and final votes.

1.1 What this guide assumes

- The committee is a conventional UN-style committee such as UNGA, ECOSOC, UNHRC, WHO, UNICEF, UNESCO, UNEP, or a similar body.
- Delegates represent Member States, observer states, NGOs, agencies, or assigned portfolios depending on the committee mandate.
- The Executive Board or Dais has authority to interpret procedure, keep order, approve documents, and announce decisions.
- Formal debate happens through a General Speakers List. Focused debate happens through moderated caucuses. Informal negotiation happens through unmoderated caucuses.
- Written solutions generally move from working paper to draft resolution to adopted resolution.

1.2 What varies from conference to conference

UNA-USA-style rules are widely used, but conferences often modify thresholds, timing, quorum, document requirements, motion precedence, and chit rules. This is especially true in Indian and South Asian MUN circuits, where chits, EB scoring, and hybrid UNA-USA/AIPPM habits are common.

Area	Common variation
Quorum	Some rulebooks use one-third to open debate and a higher threshold for substantive votes; others set quorum at a simple majority or two-thirds of registered/present delegations.
Vote thresholds	Most procedural motions pass by simple majority, but closure, tabling, and resumption often require two-thirds. Some conferences simplify this.
Draft resolution signatures	Common requirements include a minimum number of sponsors and a fraction of committee members as sponsors plus signatories. The exact number is conference-specific.
Introduction of draft resolutions	Some rulebooks treat introduction as automatic after approval; some require a procedural vote; some require authorship speeches and POIs.
Chits	Many committees allow note passing; some heavily regulate it; some score substantive chits; some ban delegate-to-delegate chits during voting or formal sessions.

1.3 The authority ladder

1. The conference handbook and committee-specific rules are the first authority.
2. The Secretary-General, Director-General, USG Committees, or equivalent Secretariat may clarify or override procedural issues.
3. The Chair/Director controls the room and rules on points and motions in real time.
4. When the rules are silent, the Chair may act to preserve fairness, order, and committee flow.
5. Delegates can question procedure through the correct points, but they should not argue procedure to derail debate.

2. The committee flow in one page

The complete committee arc is easier to understand as a sequence. Every committee has its own rhythm, but a conventional UNA-USA-style committee usually moves like this:

Step	Stage	What happens
1	Attendance and roll call	Chair calls countries; delegates respond "present" or "present and voting".
2	Quorum check	Chair confirms enough delegations are present to open debate and later to take decisions.
3	Agenda setting	For multi-topic committees, delegates set the order of topics through a motion, limited debate, and vote.
4	Open the GSL	Committee opens the General Speakers List and sets/uses a speaking time.
5	Formal debate	Delegates give policy speeches, yield time, answer POIs when permitted, and place themselves back on the GSL.
6	Moderated caucuses	Delegates motion for focused debate on subtopics; Chair recognizes speakers directly.
7	Unmoderated caucuses	Delegates negotiate informally, form blocs, merge ideas, and draft working papers.
8	Working papers	Informal documents are submitted to the Dais for review and possible circulation.
9	Draft resolutions	Fully formatted proposals with sponsors/signatories are approved by the Dais and introduced.
10	Amendments	Delegates modify draft resolutions through friendly or unfriendly amendments.
11	Closure of debate	Committee votes to stop debate and enter voting procedure, or moves there when the list is exhausted.
12	Voting procedure	Amendments are handled first, then draft resolutions. Final decisions are announced.
13	Next topic or adjournment	Committee moves to the next topic, suspends for a break, or adjourns the meeting/session.

The most important mental model

Formal debate creates the public record. Moderated caucuses focus the room. Unmoderated caucuses build the deal. Working papers organize ideas. Draft resolutions turn those ideas into voteable text.

2.1 The debate cycle

A strong committee rarely moves in a straight line. It cycles between speeches, focused debate, informal negotiation, drafting, and revision. The Chair should keep the room moving toward documents without killing genuine debate too early.

- Early committee: establish positions, identify blocs, set the agenda, and frame the problem.
- Middle committee: use moderated caucuses for sub-issues and unmoderated caucuses for bloc formation and drafting.
- Late committee: introduce draft resolutions, debate their strengths and weaknesses, consider amendments, close debate, and vote.

3. People in the room: roles and authority

3.1 Secretariat

The Secretariat is the senior conference leadership. It usually includes the Secretary-General, Director-General, USG Committees, USG Delegate Affairs, and other officers. The Secretariat sets conference policy, approves major procedural clarifications, handles disciplinary matters, and can communicate urgent changes to committees.

3.2 Executive Board / Dais

The Executive Board, often called the Dais, usually includes the Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, Director, Moderator, Rapporteur, or similar roles depending on the conference. Titles vary, but the core function remains the same: run the committee.

Role	Typical responsibilities
Chairperson / Moderator	Runs debate, recognizes speakers, rules on points and motions, maintains decorum, announces votes, and manages time.
Director / Vice-Chair	Often handles substantive accuracy, document approval, amendments, research quality, and procedural support.

Role	Typical responsibilities
Rapporteur	Tracks attendance, GSL, motions, votes, notes, document submission, and sometimes placard counts.
Pages / Volunteers	Pass chits, distribute documents, manage logistics, and support the Dais.

3.3 Delegates

Delegates are the representatives in committee. In a UN committee, a delegate usually represents a Member State, observer state, NGO, or international organization. A delegate speaks, negotiates, raises points and motions, writes documents, asks questions, votes, and preserves diplomatic decorum.

3.4 Sponsors, signatories, authors, supporters

Document roles are often misunderstood. Use these distinctions carefully:

Term	Meaning
Sponsor	A delegation that helped write and supports a draft resolution. Sponsors are politically attached to the substance.
Signatory	A delegation that wants the draft resolution debated. A signatory does not necessarily support the document.
Author	Often used for working papers or in Indian circuits. Similar to sponsor, but terminology varies.
Supporter	Often used for working papers. Indicates support for circulation or discussion, not always full substantive endorsement.

Chairing note

Do not let delegates weaponize document labels. A signatory is not automatically a supporter. A sponsor should know and defend the text. A working paper supporter may simply agree that the idea deserves discussion.

4. Attendance, roll call, credentials, and quorum

4.1 Attendance before formal proceedings

Before the first formal session begins, the Dais should confirm which delegations are physically present, which are absent, and which are observers or non-voting participants. This affects quorum, vote thresholds, speaking order, and document signature calculations.

- The Rapporteur should maintain an attendance sheet for each session.
- Late arrivals should report to the Dais before participating.
- Observer delegations should be clearly marked because they may not have substantive voting rights.
- Delegates should sit behind their placards and respond clearly during roll call.

4.2 Roll call responses

Response	Meaning	Voting consequence
Present	The delegation is in the room and participates in debate.	May vote Yes, No, or Abstain on substantive votes, unless the committee rules say otherwise.
Present and voting	The delegation is in the room and promises to take a definite position on substantive votes.	May vote Yes or No on substantive votes; may not abstain.
Absent	The delegation is not in the room when called.	Does not count as present for that roll call. A late delegate should check in with the Dais.
Observer / Non-voting	The delegation may speak if recognized, depending on mandate.	Usually cannot vote on substantive matters; may or may not vote on procedural matters depending on the committee.

4.3 Quorum

Quorum is the minimum presence required for the committee to open, debate, or vote. It protects legitimacy: a committee should not make decisions when too few members are present.

Practical rule

Announce quorum clearly. Do not assume delegates know whether the room is legally able to proceed. The Dais should say whether quorum is met and what number was used.

Common quorum models

Model	How it works	Where you may see it
One-third to open	The committee can open when at least one-third of members are present; a higher threshold may be needed for final decisions.	Used in some UN-inspired training contexts and some conference handbooks.
Simple majority to open or vote	More than half of eligible delegations must be present.	Common in simplified school-level procedure.
Two-thirds of first roll call	Quorum is set at two-thirds of delegations present at first roll call.	Appears in some UNA-USA-style conference adaptations.
Conference-specific number	The Dais announces a number based on the conference handbook.	Best practice when a conference has issued its own ROP.

Quorum examples

- If 60 delegations are registered and quorum is one-third, at least 20 must be present to open.
- If 60 delegations are registered and quorum is simple majority, at least 31 must be present.
- If 45 delegations are present on the first roll call and quorum is two-thirds of that number, quorum is 30.
- If voting threshold is based on delegations present during the last roll call, the Rapporteur must keep the latest roll call figure accurate.

4.4 Late arrivals and re-entry

A delegate who arrives late should not interrupt debate. They should quietly approach the Dais or send a note, indicate whether they are present or present and voting if allowed, and wait for the Chair to update the attendance record. During voting procedure, late entry is usually prohibited once doors are secured.

4.5 Attendance script

Roll call script

Chair: The committee will now begin roll call. When your delegation is called, please respond with "present" or "present and voting."
 Rapporteur: Afghanistan?
 Delegate: Present.
 Rapporteur: Albania?
 Delegate: Present and voting.
 Chair: With [number] delegations present, quorum is [met/not met]. The committee is now in session.

5. Opening the committee and setting the agenda

5.1 Opening the meeting

After roll call and quorum, the Chair formally opens the meeting. The opening statement should be brief: remind delegates of decorum, identify the agenda situation, and invite the first motions in order.

Opening script

Chair: Delegates, quorum has been met. This meeting of [committee name] is now called to order.
 Chair: The Dais reminds delegates to maintain diplomatic decorum, use third-person parliamentary language, and raise all points and motions through the Chair.
 Chair: The floor is now open. Are there any points or motions?

5.2 One-topic vs multi-topic committees

If the committee has only one agenda item, it usually proceeds directly to opening the General Speakers List. If there are two or more topics, the first major procedural action is setting the agenda order.

5.3 Motion to set the agenda

A motion to set the agenda chooses which topic the committee will discuss first. In many UNA-USA-style rules, this motion requires a second, limited debate for and against, and then a simple majority vote.

Motion language

Delegate: The delegation of [country] moves to set the agenda in the order of Topic 1 followed by Topic 2.
 Chair: That motion is in order. Are there any seconds?
 Chair: Seeing seconds, we will open a provisional speakers list with speakers for and against the motion.

5.4 Provisional speakers list

During agenda setting, a temporary or provisional speakers list may be opened. Delegates speak for or against the proposed topic order, not about the full substance of the agenda. After the list is exhausted, the committee votes.

- Speeches should focus on why a topic should be prioritized.
- The Chair should prevent delegates from turning agenda-setting speeches into full policy speeches.
- Once the agenda order is adopted, the committee proceeds to the first topic.

Common mistake

A delegate says, "Motion to set the agenda to Topic 1" in a two-topic committee. Better: "Motion to set the agenda in the order of Topic 1 followed by Topic 2." The motion should clearly state the order.

6. General Speakers List (GSL) and formal debate

6.1 What the GSL is

The General Speakers List, or GSL, is the backbone of formal debate. It is a list of delegations who want to speak on the agenda item. The Chair calls speakers in order. The GSL remains open unless the committee closes it or moves into another mode of debate.

6.2 Opening the GSL

Opening the GSL

Delegate: The delegation of [country] moves to open the General Speakers List with a speaking time of 90 seconds.
 Chair: That motion is in order. Are there any seconds?
 Chair: Seeing seconds and no objections, the General Speakers List is now open with a speaking time of 90 seconds. Delegates wishing to be added may raise their placards or send a note to the Dais.

6.3 How delegates get added

- Raise your placard when the Chair asks which delegations wish to be added.
- Send a chit or note to the Dais: "The delegation of [country] requests to be added to the GSL."

- After speaking, you may usually request to be added again, but not twice on the list at the same time unless the Chair allows it.

6.4 What a GSL speech should do

A GSL speech is a broad policy speech. It should establish your country position, identify the problem, frame priorities, and suggest possible solutions. It should not become a clause-by-clause technical explanation unless the committee is debating a draft resolution.

Speech part	Purpose	Example language
Hook / urgency	Show why the agenda matters.	The delegation of Kenya believes that food insecurity is not a future threat; it is a present governance challenge.
Country stance	State national policy and interests.	Kenya supports climate-resilient agriculture, regional early warning systems, and financing for smallholder farmers.
Evidence / impact	Add credibility without overloading the room.	Drought cycles have shown that prevention is cheaper than emergency relief.
Solutions	Move debate toward action.	This committee should prioritize technical assistance, public-private grain storage, and local capacity-building.
Diplomatic close	Invite cooperation.	We look forward to working with delegations that support practical, funded, and locally led solutions.

6.5 Speaking time

The Chair may set default speaking time, often 60, 90, or 120 seconds. Delegates can motion to change speaking time if the rules allow it. The Chair should call a speaker to order when time expires.

6.6 End of the GSL

If the speakers list is exhausted and no other business is pending, many UNA-USA-style procedures move the committee toward voting procedure on introduced draft resolutions and amendments. In practice, the Chair usually warns delegates before the list is exhausted so the committee is not surprised.

Chairing note

Keep the GSL active. Warn delegates before the list is exhausted so the committee does not enter voting procedure before documents are ready.

7. Yields and Points of Information

7.1 What a yield is

A yield tells the Chair what should happen with unused speaking time after a formal speech. In common UNA-USA-style rules, yields are generally available after a delegate speaks on a substantive issue in formal debate, especially on the GSL. Yields are usually not allowed in moderated caucuses.

Yield type	Meaning	Delegate phrase
Yield to the Chair	The delegate gives remaining time back to the Chair. Debate moves on.	The delegation yields its remaining time to the Chair.
Yield to another delegate	Another delegation receives the remaining time. The second delegate usually may not yield again.	The delegation yields its remaining time to the delegate of Brazil.
Yield to Points of Information	Other delegates ask questions, usually one at a time through the Chair.	The delegation yields to two Points of Information.

7.2 Points of Information (POIs)

A Point of Information is a question directed to a speaker, not a comment disguised as a question. It should be short, relevant, and answerable. The Chair may reject aggressive, irrelevant, repetitive, or speech-like POIs.

Good POI	Weak POI
Could the delegate clarify how their proposal would be funded?	Does the delegate not realize that their entire policy is unrealistic?

Good POI	Weak POI
Would the delegate support including regional monitoring in the draft resolution?	The delegate is wrong because my country has already solved this problem, correct?
How would the proposed sanctions avoid harming civilians?	Is the delegate aware of every historical example of failed sanctions?

7.3 How the Chair should handle POIs

6. Speaker yields to a specific number of POIs or to POIs generally, depending on rules.
7. Chair recognizes one delegate to ask a question.
8. The question must be short and relevant.
9. The speaker answers within remaining time.
10. Chair repeats until time expires or the allowed number of POIs is complete.

No speeches through POIs

A POI is not a backdoor speech. If the delegate begins with a long preamble, the Chair should interrupt politely: "Please state your question."

8. Points: what delegates can interrupt for

Points are tools for personal comfort, procedural correction, clarification, or questioning. They are not motions. They do not move the committee into a new debate format. They help the committee function properly.

Point	Use	Can it interrupt?	Example
Point of Personal Privilege	Personal comfort, safety, audibility, or inability to participate.	Only if urgent, especially audibility.	Point of Personal Privilege: the delegate cannot hear the speaker.
Point of Order	A procedural error by the Chair or committee.	Only if immediate correction is necessary and Chair permits.	Point of Order: the motion requires a second under the rules.
Point of Parliamentary Inquiry	A question to the Chair about procedure or current committee status.	No.	Point of Parliamentary Inquiry: what motions are currently in order?
Point of Information	A question to a speaker after a speech, usually only when the speaker yields to POIs.	No.	Point of Information: would the delegate support clause-level monitoring?
Point of Clarification	Optional point used in some circuits for definitions or document wording.	No.	Point of Clarification: what does the phrase "capacity building" refer to in Clause 3?

8.1 Point of Personal Privilege

Use this when the delegate cannot participate because of a comfort or safety issue: cannot hear, microphone not working, room too cold, health concern, or serious personal need. It should not be used to make political points.

8.2 Point of Order

Use this when there is a procedural mistake. A Point of Order should be specific and respectful. The delegate should not argue the substance of the agenda while raising it.

Point of Order script

Delegate: Point of Order.
 Chair: Please state your point.
 Delegate: The motion to close debate requires two speakers against before a vote, according to the rules.
 Chair: Your point is well taken. The Dais will now entertain speakers against the motion.

8.3 Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

Use this to ask the Chair about procedure: what motions are in order, whether a draft resolution has been introduced, how much time remains, or whether a point is appropriate. It cannot interrupt a speaker.

8.4 Point of Information

Use this as a question to another delegate, normally after a speech and only when the speaker yields to questions or when the Chair specifically entertains questions.

8.5 Right of Reply

A Right of Reply is not a normal point. It is a request for permission to respond to a grave personal or national insult. It is usually submitted in writing to the Chair after the offending speech. The Chair has discretion and may deny weak or political requests.

8.6 Appeal to the Chair

Some conferences allow a delegate to appeal a Chair ruling in writing. This is serious and should be rare. It is not a tool for irritation or tactical delay. Usually, appeals go to the Secretariat or senior committee staff.

Delegate discipline

Most points should be short enough to state in one sentence. If a delegate needs a paragraph, it is probably a speech, not a point.

9. Motions: how committee actually moves

9.1 What a motion is

A motion is a formal proposal that asks the committee to do something: set the agenda, open the GSL, enter a caucus, introduce a document, close debate, suspend the meeting, or adjourn. Motions are raised only when the floor is open for points or motions.

9.2 The standard motion cycle

11. Chair opens the floor for points or motions.
12. Delegate raises a motion using correct wording.
13. Chair rules whether the motion is in order.
14. Chair asks for seconds if required.
15. Chair entertains competing motions if appropriate.
16. Committee votes on motions in order of precedence or disruptiveness.
17. If the motion passes, the Chair implements it immediately.

9.3 Procedural vs substantive votes

Vote type	Meaning
Procedural vote	A vote about how the committee will operate: caucuses, suspensions, agenda setting, closure, tabling, speaking time, and similar matters. Abstentions are usually not allowed.
Substantive vote	A vote on content: draft resolutions and unfriendly amendments. Abstentions may be allowed for delegations marked present, but not for delegations marked present and voting.

9.4 Majority thresholds

Most routine procedural motions pass by simple majority. More disruptive motions, such as closure of debate, tabling, resumption, and adjournment, may require two-thirds depending on the conference. Draft resolutions often pass by simple majority in General Assembly-style committees, while the Security Council has special rules.

Threshold	Plain meaning	Example if 40 delegations are present
Simple majority	More Yes than the required half; often 50 percent plus one of those present or voting, depending on rules.	Usually 21 Yes votes if based on members present.
Two-thirds majority	At least two-thirds support.	27 Yes votes if 40 are present.
Consensus	No formal opposition or no objection.	Chair may ask: "Are there any objections? Seeing none, the motion passes."

Threshold	Plain meaning	Example if 40 delegations are present
Security Council rule	Nine affirmative votes and no veto by a permanent member in many simulations.	Special committee-specific calculation.

9.5 Disruptiveness and precedence

When several motions are raised at once, the Chair chooses the order of voting. Many UNA-USA-style rules list an order of procedural precedence, with points first and adjournment/closure/tabling treated as high-impact motions. For caucuses, the Chair often votes on the most disruptive motion first, commonly the longest unmoderated caucus or the caucus that most changes the current debate.

Simple chair test

Ask: Which motion would most change what the committee is currently doing? Vote on that first, unless the conference handbook gives a specific order.

9.6 Exact wording for common motions

Motion	Delegate wording
Open GSL	The delegation of [country] moves to open the General Speakers List with a speaking time of [time].
Moderated caucus	The delegation of [country] moves for a moderated caucus on [topic], for a total time of [minutes], with individual speaking time of [seconds].
Unmoderated caucus	The delegation of [country] moves for an unmoderated caucus for [minutes].
Extend caucus	The delegation of [country] moves to extend the previous caucus by [minutes].
Introduce draft resolution	The delegation of [country] moves to introduce Draft Resolution [number].
Closure of debate	The delegation of [country] moves for closure of debate on this topic.
Suspend meeting	The delegation of [country] moves to suspend the meeting until [time/session].
Adjourn meeting	The delegation of [country] moves to adjourn the meeting.

10. Moderated caucuses

10.1 What a moderated caucus is

A moderated caucus is a focused, semi-formal debate on a specific subtopic. The committee temporarily leaves the GSL. The Chair calls on delegates directly, usually by placard, and each speaker has a short individual speaking time. Yields are normally out of order.

10.2 Motion requirements

Required element	Why it matters	Example
Topic	Keeps debate focused.	Impact of climate change on coastal displacement
Total duration	Tells the committee how long the caucus lasts.	10 minutes
Individual speaking time	Controls each intervention.	45 seconds per speaker
Purpose, if asked	Explains why the caucus helps committee flow.	To identify funding mechanisms for adaptation

Moderated caucus motion

Delegate: The delegation of Bangladesh moves for a 10-minute moderated caucus on climate-induced displacement, with a 45-second speaking time.
 Chair: That motion is in order. Are there any seconds?
 Chair: Seeing seconds, this motion requires a simple majority. All those in favor? All those against?
 Chair: The motion passes. Delegates wishing to speak, please raise your placards.

10.3 When to use a moderated caucus

- To break a broad topic into manageable sub-issues.
- To compare country positions after several GSL speeches.
- To test support for solutions before drafting.

- To debate a specific working paper or draft resolution after it is introduced.
- To create momentum when the GSL is too slow or repetitive.

10.4 Good moderated caucus topics

Weak topic	Better topic
Solutions to terrorism	Countering terrorist financing through regional intelligence sharing
Climate change	Funding loss-and-damage response for small island developing states
Women rights	Legal protection and reporting mechanisms for gender-based violence
Healthcare	Equitable vaccine distribution in low-income states
Refugees	Burden-sharing mechanisms for host countries

10.5 Chairing a moderated caucus

18. Restate the topic, total time, and speaking time.
19. Ask delegates to raise placards if they wish to speak.
20. Choose speakers with balance across blocs and regions.
21. Cut off speeches when time expires.
22. Do not allow yields unless conference rules specifically allow them.
23. At the end, open the floor for points or motions.

Delegate strategy

Use moderated caucuses to become associated with a clear policy lane. Do not speak on every topic. Speak when you can add a solution, coalition invitation, evidence, or challenge that moves the room.

11. Unmoderated caucuses

11.1 What an unmoderated caucus is

An unmoderated caucus is a temporary break from formal speaking order for informal negotiation. Delegates may move around the room, speak directly, form blocs, merge ideas, and draft documents. The Chair does not recognize individual speakers, but decorum and conference rules still apply.

11.2 Motion requirements

A motion for an unmoderated caucus usually requires a total duration. It does not require individual speaking time because there is no formal speaking order.

Unmoderated caucus motion

Delegate: The delegation of Brazil moves for a 15-minute unmoderated caucus for the purpose of bloc formation and working paper drafting.
 Chair: That motion is in order. Are there any seconds?
 Chair: Seeing seconds, we will now vote. All those in favor? All those against?
 Chair: The motion passes. Delegates, you have 15 minutes. Please remain inside the committee room unless given permission by the Dais.

11.3 What delegates should do during an unmoderated caucus

Minute range	Best use of time
0-2	Find allies and gather around a clear policy theme.
2-5	Choose a bloc coordinator, drafter, speaker, and negotiator.
5-10	List proposed clauses and assign drafting tasks.
10-13	Merge overlapping ideas and identify likely sponsors/signatories.
13-15	Prepare next motion, next speaker, or document submission to the Dais.

11.4 Bloc formation

A bloc is a group of delegations working together on a shared proposal. Blocs should form around policy compatibility, not friendship. A smart bloc includes geographic diversity, major stakeholders, affected countries, donor countries, and technical experts where relevant.

- Do not create a giant bloc with no coherent policy. It will collapse during drafting.
- Do not isolate smaller delegations. They can provide crucial votes and legitimacy.
- Assign tasks early: preamble, operative clauses, sponsorship list, signatories, speech defense, amendment negotiation.
- Document all clause owners so the bloc knows who can explain each idea.

11.5 Chairing an unmoderated caucus

- Announce start and end time clearly.
- Keep delegates in the room unless rules allow exit.
- Monitor for harassment, excessive noise, or exclusionary behavior.
- Visit blocs to check document progress without writing the document for them.
- Give warnings at halfway and one minute remaining.
- When time expires, call the committee back to order immediately.

Reality check

Most resolutions are won or lost in unmoderated caucus. If your bloc has no document plan by the end of the first serious unmod, you are drifting.

12. Suspension, tabling, closure, and adjournment

These motions affect the larger structure of debate. They are more disruptive than routine caucus motions and should be used carefully.

Motion	Purpose	Typical threshold / notes
Suspend the meeting	Pauses the current meeting for a break, lunch, end of committee session, or scheduled recess.	Usually simple majority or Chair discretion. Debate resumes later.
Table debate	Sets aside the current topic without voting on it, usually to move to another topic or urgent matter.	Often two-thirds. Usually allows limited speakers for and against.
Resume debate	Returns to a tabled topic.	Often same threshold as tabling, commonly two-thirds.
Closure of debate	Ends debate on the current topic and moves to voting procedure on pending draft resolutions/amendments.	Often two-thirds. Usually only speakers against are entertained.
Adjourn the meeting	Ends the meeting. Final adjournment ends the committee session/conference.	Often high threshold or Chair discretion; not used casually.

12.1 Motion to suspend the meeting

Use this for scheduled breaks or the end of a committee session when the committee will reconvene. It does not kill the topic or documents. It simply pauses the meeting.

12.2 Motion to table debate

Tabling debate is serious. It pauses discussion of the current topic, usually so the committee can address another topic or crisis. If passed, no further action is taken on the tabled topic until debate is resumed.

12.3 Closure of debate

Closure of debate means the committee believes discussion is complete and wants to enter voting procedure. This should happen only when draft resolutions and amendments are ready and introduced. If closure passes too early, good ideas can die unfinished.

Closure of debate script

Delegate: The delegation of [country] moves for closure of debate on this topic.
 Chair: That motion is in order. Are there any seconds?
 Chair: Seeing seconds, the Dais will entertain up to two speakers against this motion.
 Chair: We will now vote. This motion requires [threshold]. All those in favor? All those against?
 Chair: The motion passes. Debate is now closed, and the committee will enter voting procedure.

12.4 Adjournment

Adjournment ends the meeting. During normal conference days, use suspension rather than adjournment unless the rulebook says otherwise. Final adjournment ends the committee permanently.

Chairing note

Do not allow delegates to confuse suspension, tabling, closure, and adjournment. These motions sound similar to beginners but have very different consequences.

13. Working papers

13.1 Definition

A working paper is an informal written proposal that collects ideas, policies, frameworks, or draft clauses. It is a bridge between debate and a formal draft resolution. It does not need to follow full UN resolution format unless the Chair requires it.

13.2 What working papers are for

- Organizing bloc ideas before formal resolution drafting.
- Testing whether the committee supports a policy direction.
- Combining similar proposals from different blocs.
- Giving the Dais a concrete document to evaluate for feasibility and relevance.
- Preparing language that may later become operative clauses in a draft resolution.

13.3 Common submission requirements

Requirements vary. The Dais may ask for a minimum number of authors/supporters, a clear title, country list, and enough substance to justify circulation. Some conferences require a percentage of committee support before circulation.

Element	Recommended practice
Title	Use a descriptive title: "Working Paper 1.1: Regional Early Warning and Response".
Authors / supporters	List delegations that wrote or support discussion of the document.
Problem statement	One short paragraph defining the issue.
Proposed actions	Bullet points or rough operative clauses.
Implementation notes	Funding, timeline, agencies, monitoring, and stakeholder roles.
Submission to Dais	Send in the format required by the conference: Google Doc, printed copy, email, USB, or committee portal.

13.4 Working paper lifecycle

24. Bloc discusses policy during unmoderated caucus.
25. Delegates draft a working paper.
26. Dais reviews for relevance, quality, and basic feasibility.
27. Chair approves circulation or returns it for revision.
28. Committee debates it through GSL, moderated caucus, or informal negotiation.
29. Working paper is revised into a properly formatted draft resolution.

13.5 Sample working paper

Working Paper 1.1 - Food Security Early Warning

Authors: Kenya, Brazil, Bangladesh

Supporters: Mexico, Ghana, Indonesia, Norway

Problem: Climate shocks, conflict, and price instability are increasing food insecurity in vulnerable regions.

Proposed framework:

1. Create a voluntary regional early warning network using national meteorological agencies and FAO technical support.
2. Establish emergency grain storage partnerships in high-risk regions.
3. Support smallholder farmers through climate-resilient seeds, irrigation training, and microcredit access.
4. Encourage transparent reporting of food price spikes to prevent hoarding and panic buying.

Important

A working paper is not voted on in most UNA-USA-style committees. It is discussed, improved, and transformed. A draft resolution is the voteable document.

14. Draft resolutions

14.1 Definition

A draft resolution is a formal, voteable document that proposes the committee's solution to the agenda. It uses UN-style resolution structure: heading, preambulatory clauses, and operative clauses. It must be approved by the Dais before introduction.

14.2 Sponsors and signatories

A draft resolution normally requires sponsors and signatories. The exact number is set by the conference. Sponsors support the substance. Signatories only want the document debated. A signatory can vote against the draft resolution later.

14.3 Anatomy of a draft resolution

Part	Purpose	Notes
Heading	Identifies committee, topic, sponsors, signatories, and draft number.	The Dais usually assigns the final number, such as Draft Resolution 1.1.
Preamble	Explains context, past UN action, legal basis, and reasons for action.	Preambulatory clauses usually begin with italicized/underlined participles such as Recognizing, Recalling, Deeply concerned.
Operative clauses	State the actions the committee recommends, requests, encourages, or decides.	Operative clauses are numbered and usually end with semicolons; the final clause ends with a period.

14.4 From working paper to draft resolution

30. Make sure the policy ideas address the agenda and committee mandate.
31. Merge overlapping working papers where possible.
32. Convert rough ideas into operative clauses with clear actors, actions, funding, timeline, and monitoring.
33. Write preambulatory clauses that justify the action without becoming too long.
34. Collect sponsors and signatories according to conference requirements.
35. Submit to the Dais for approval.
36. Revise if the Dais returns it for formatting or substance issues.
37. Once approved, move to introduce the draft resolution.

14.5 Introduction of a draft resolution

After Dais approval, a delegate may motion to introduce the draft resolution. Some UNA-USA-style guides treat this introduction as automatically approved; others require a procedural vote. During introduction, the sponsor usually summarizes the operative clauses. Yields and comments are usually out of order during the introduction itself.

Introduction script

Delegate: The delegation of Kenya moves to introduce Draft Resolution 1.1.

Chair: That motion is in order. [Depending on rules: This motion is automatically approved / We will now vote on introduction.]

Chair: Sponsors may approach the podium to introduce the draft resolution. Please limit your remarks to the operative clauses.

Sponsor: Draft Resolution 1.1 establishes a regional early warning network, supports emergency grain storage, and creates a voluntary reporting mechanism for price spikes.

Chair: Thank you, delegate. The committee will now return to debate. Questions and comments may be raised through the speakers list, motions, or points as appropriate.

14.6 What makes a strong draft resolution

- It is within the mandate of the committee.
- It identifies specific actors: Member States, UN agencies, regional organizations, NGOs, or funds.
- It includes implementation, not just ideals.
- It uses realistic funding mechanisms.
- It avoids violating sovereignty unless the committee mandate supports stronger action.
- It has broad sponsorship and enough signatories to show committee interest.
- Its operative clauses can survive hostile questions.

15. Amendments

15.1 Definition

An amendment changes a draft resolution after it has been introduced. Amendments can add, delete, or modify clauses. They help the committee improve text without rewriting the entire document.

Type	Meaning	How it is handled
Friendly amendment	Accepted by all sponsors of the draft resolution.	Usually adopted automatically after Dais approval.
Unfriendly amendment	Not accepted by all sponsors but supported by enough delegations to be considered.	Requires Dais approval and a substantive vote by the committee.
Amendment to an amendment	A proposed change to an amendment.	Usually out of order in UNA-USA-style procedure.

15.2 Amendment submission checklist

- Identify the draft resolution number.
- Identify the exact clause to be amended.
- State whether the amendment adds, deletes, or modifies text.
- Include required sponsors/signatories if it is unfriendly.
- Submit in the required format to the Dais.
- Wait for Dais approval before moving to introduce or debate it.

15.3 Sample amendment language

Friendly amendment sample

Draft Resolution: 1.1

Type: Friendly amendment

Sponsors approving: Kenya, Brazil, Bangladesh

Action: Add new operative clause after Clause 4:

5. Encourages Member States to share anonymized food price data with regional early warning bodies every quarter;

Unfriendly amendment sample

Draft Resolution: 1.1
 Type: Unfriendly amendment
 Submitted by: Argentina, India, South Africa
 Action: Replace Operative Clause 3 with:
 3. Requests FAO, in partnership with regional organizations, to create voluntary technical assistance teams for drought-risk mapping;

15.4 Voting on amendments

Unfriendly amendments are usually voted on before the draft resolution as a whole. If several amendments exist, the Chair may determine the order, often beginning with the amendment that most significantly changes the draft resolution. Once amendments are decided, the committee votes on the final amended draft resolution.

Delegate strategy

Do not use unfriendly amendments just to score points. Use them when sponsors refuse a necessary change and you can build enough support to pass it.

16. Voting procedure

16.1 When voting procedure begins

Voting procedure begins after closure of debate passes, after the GSL is exhausted under rules that trigger voting, or when the Chair announces that the committee is moving into voting procedure according to the rulebook. Once voting begins, the room changes: movement, communication, and interruptions are heavily restricted.

16.2 Conduct during voting

- No delegate may enter or leave the room unless the Chair permits it under exceptional circumstances.
- No delegate-to-delegate communication is allowed.
- Chits are suspended except urgent points directly related to voting conduct, if allowed.
- Only points related to comfort, procedure, or the actual conduct of voting may be entertained.
- The Dais secures doors, collects vote counts, and announces results clearly.

16.3 Order of voting

38. Unfriendly amendments are voted on first.
39. If multiple amendments exist, the Chair determines order according to the rules.
40. The draft resolution, as amended, is voted on next.
41. If multiple draft resolutions are on the floor, they are usually voted in the order introduced or submitted unless the committee reorders them under permitted rules.
42. After all draft resolutions are voted upon, the committee either moves to the next topic or closes the session.

16.4 Methods of voting

Method	How it works	When used
Placard vote	Delegates raise placards for Yes, No, and Abstain if allowed.	Most procedural votes and many substantive votes.
Roll call vote	Delegations are called alphabetically and respond Yes, No, Abstain, Pass, or Yes/No with rights if allowed.	Substantive votes when requested or directed by the Chair.
Acclamation / unanimous consent	Chair asks if there are objections; if none, motion passes.	Routine procedural matters where rules allow.
Recorded vote	Votes are recorded by delegation.	More formal committees or major substantive votes.

16.5 Roll call voting

In a roll call vote, the Chair or Rapporteur calls each delegation. Delegates may usually respond Yes, No, Abstain, or Pass, unless they are present and voting. If a delegation passes in the first round, it is called again in a second round and may usually only vote Yes or No. Voting with rights allows a delegate to explain an unusual vote after voting but before results are announced, if the Chair permits it.

16.6 Present vs present and voting in substantive votes

Roll call status	Can vote Yes?	Can vote No?	Can Abstain?
Present	Yes	Yes	Usually yes
Present and voting	Yes	Yes	No
Observer / NGO	Usually no on substantive matters	Usually no on substantive matters	Not applicable

16.7 Draft resolution passage

In most General Assembly-style MUN committees, draft resolutions pass by simple majority unless the committee rules say otherwise. Security Council simulations use special rules involving permanent members. Always calculate based on the conference handbook: majority of members present, members voting, or members present and voting are not the same thing.

Counting warning

Never announce a result until the Rapporteur and Chair agree on the count and threshold. A one-vote error can destroy trust in the Dais.

Voting procedure script

Chair: Debate is now closed. The committee is in voting procedure. Delegates may not enter or leave the room, and all communication is suspended.
 Chair: We will first vote on unfriendly amendments, then on draft resolutions.
 Chair: All those in favor of Amendment 1.1A? All those against? Abstentions?
 Chair: Amendment 1.1A [passes/fails].
 Chair: We will now vote on Draft Resolution 1.1 as amended. All those in favor? All those against? Abstentions?
 Chair: With [number] in favor, [number] against, and [number] abstentions, Draft Resolution 1.1 [passes/fails].

17. Chits / note passing

17.1 Chits vs notes

In many MUN circuits, especially in India and South Asia, written notes are called chits. The user may hear this mispronounced as "chips," but the common term is chits. In many UNA-USA committees outside these circuits, the same practice is simply called note passing.

Important status note

Chits are not a core parliamentary motion in classic UNA-USA procedure. They are an operational communication tool. Some conferences allow them freely, some route them through the Dais, some score them, and some restrict them heavily.

17.2 Why chits matter

- They let delegates coordinate during formal debate without interrupting speakers.
- They help blocs form before the next unmoderated caucus.
- They allow delegates to ask clarifying questions when they are not recognized orally.
- They let delegates send substantive analysis to the Dais when speaking time is limited.
- They create a record of active diplomacy in circuits where the EB evaluates chits.

17.3 Common chit types

Type	Recipient	Purpose	Example
To EB / Dais chit	Executive Board	Procedural query, substantive note, request to be added to GSL, document clarification.	To EB: The delegation requests to be added to the GSL.
Via EB chit	Another delegate through the Dais	Formal delegate-to-delegate communication that the EB may screen.	To Brazil via EB: Would Brazil support adding monitoring language to Clause 4?
Direct delegate chit	Another delegate	Informal lobbying or coordination if rules allow direct note passing.	To Ghana: Let us meet in the next unmod to merge food security clauses.
POI chit	Speaker through Dais	Written question when oral POIs are limited or not recognized.	To Kenya via EB: Could the delegate clarify the funding source for the proposed early warning network?
Substantive chit	Usually EB	A concise policy argument, evidence point, or solution idea for evaluation.	To EB: The delegation submits that regional data sharing should be voluntary to preserve sovereignty.
Reply chit	Questioner or EB	Written response to a prior note or question.	To Mexico via EB: We can accept voluntary reporting but not mandatory inspections.

17.4 Basic chit format

Standard chit format

To: [Country / Executive Board] From: [Your country] Route: [Direct / Via EB / To EB] Type: [POI / Substantive / Procedural / Coordination] Message: [One clear purpose in 1-5 sentences] Optional: Source or clause reference, if making a factual claim
--

17.5 Good vs bad chits

Weak chit	Strong chit
Can we work together?	Our bloc is drafting on rural health access. Would your delegation co-sponsor language on mobile clinics if funding is voluntary?
Your speech was wrong.	Could the delegate clarify whether their sanctions proposal includes humanitarian exemptions?
Add me to everything.	The delegation of South Africa requests to be added to the GSL.
We have better ideas.	To EB: Our delegation proposes adding a monitoring mechanism through annual voluntary reporting to avoid sovereignty concerns.

17.6 Chit etiquette

- Never send anonymous chits unless the committee explicitly permits it, which is rare.
- Do not insult delegates or make personal comments.
- Assume the Dais may read any chit routed through EB.
- Keep one purpose per chit.
- Write legibly and identify countries clearly.
- Do not use chits during voting procedure unless the Chair allows urgent procedural points.
- Do not spam the Dais. Quality beats quantity.
- Do not fabricate evidence. If you cite data, include a source or enough context for the Dais to evaluate it.

17.7 Chit strategy for delegates

Committee stage	Best chit use
Opening speeches	Identify allies and policy overlap.
Early moderated caucuses	Ask focused POIs and test whether delegates support your policy lane.
First unmoderated caucus	Invite specific delegations into your bloc and assign drafting roles.
Working paper phase	Ask for support, suggest clauses, and coordinate mergers.
Draft resolution phase	Negotiate sponsor/signatory lists and potential amendments.
Pre-voting	Clarify final positions before voting procedure begins; stop all communication once voting begins.

18. Chair scripts and committee language

Good chairing language is predictable, neutral, and concise. Delegates should always know what is happening, what is being voted on, and what is in order.

Opening floor for motions

Chair: The floor is now open for points or motions.
 Chair: Delegates wishing to raise a point or motion, please raise your placards.
 Chair: The Chair recognizes the delegate of [country].

Ruling a motion in order

Delegate: The delegation of [country] moves for a 10-minute moderated caucus on [topic], with a 45-second speaking time.
 Chair: Thank you, delegate. That motion is in order. Are there any seconds?
 Chair: Seeing seconds, we will vote on this motion. All those in favor? All those against?

Ruling a motion out of order

Delegate: The delegation of [country] moves to introduce Draft Resolution 1.1.
 Chair: Thank you, delegate. That motion is out of order at this time because Draft Resolution 1.1 has not yet been approved by the Dais.
 Chair: The floor remains open for points or motions.

Calling a speaker to order

Chair: Delegate, please confine your remarks to the agenda item.
 Chair: Delegate, your time has elapsed. Please yield your remaining time if applicable or return to your seat.
 Chair: Delegate, please state your question. Points of Information must be questions, not speeches.

Returning from unmoderated caucus

Chair: Delegates, the time for the unmoderated caucus has elapsed. Please return to your seats.
 Chair: The committee will come back to order in 10 seconds.
 Chair: The committee is now back in formal session. The floor is open for points or motions.

Announcing document approval

Chair: The Dais has approved Working Paper 1.1 for circulation.
 Chair: The Dais has approved Draft Resolution 1.1. Delegates may now motion to introduce it when the floor is open.

Announcing results

Chair: With [number] votes in favor, [number] against, and [number] abstentions, Draft Resolution 1.1 passes.
 Chair: Congratulations, delegates. The committee has adopted Resolution 1.1.

18.1 Diplomatic delegate language

Avoid	Use instead
I think...	The delegation of [country] believes...
You are wrong.	The delegation respectfully disagrees with the delegate's assessment.
My country wants...	The government of [country] supports...
Can I ask you...	Would the delegate clarify...
We made this resolution.	The sponsors of Draft Resolution 1.1 propose...

19. Delegate strategy and training drills

19.1 First-hour delegate checklist

- Respond clearly during roll call.
- Know whether you are present or present and voting.
- Make or support a sensible motion to open the GSL or set the agenda.
- Get on the GSL early.
- Give a clear first speech with country stance and two possible solutions.
- Send chits to likely allies after their speeches.
- Support moderated caucuses that match your policy priorities.
- Use the first unmoderated caucus to form or join a bloc.
- Start drafting before everyone else starts arguing about wording.

19.2 Chair training drill: motion recognition

Give trainees a stack of motion cards. Each card has a delegate phrase. The trainee must decide whether it is in order, what information is missing, whether it needs a second, and what threshold applies. This builds fast procedural judgment.

19.3 Delegate drill: 45-second moderated caucus speech

Ask delegates to speak on a narrow topic in 45 seconds using this structure: problem, country stance, specific solution, coalition invitation. This trains concision and policy clarity.

45-second speech structure

Problem: What specific part of the agenda are we solving?
 Country stance: What does my country support or oppose?
 Solution: What should the committee do?
 Coalition invitation: Who should work with us and why?

19.4 Drafting drill: from vague idea to operative clause

Vague idea	Better operative clause direction
Help refugees	Calls upon UNHCR and willing Member States to expand voluntary registration support and legal aid services in host communities;
Stop climate change	Encourages Member States to adopt nationally appropriate renewable energy transition plans with technical support from UNEP;
Educate people	Requests UNESCO to support teacher-training modules on digital literacy in partnership with national education ministries;
More funding	Recommends establishing a voluntary multi-donor trust fund administered by [relevant body] for capacity-building projects;

19.5 Common mistakes

Mistake	Why it hurts	Fix
Making motions without required details	The Chair must rule them out or ask for correction.	Include topic, total time, and speaker time for moderated caucus.
Treating POIs as speeches	It wastes time and annoys the Dais.	Ask one direct question.
Waiting too long to draft	Other blocs control the text.	Start working paper language early.
Confusing signatories with sponsors	Creates false assumptions about support.	Explain document roles clearly.
Overusing unmoderated caucuses	Committee loses public debate and direction.	Alternate unmods with focused moderated caucuses.
Trying to close debate too early	Documents and amendments may be unfinished.	Close debate only when the committee is ready to vote.
Ignoring voting math	Blocs miscalculate passage.	Track present, present and voting, abstentions, and thresholds.

19.6 Educator facilitation plan

For classroom training, divide a 90-minute session like this:

Time	Activity
0-10 min	Explain roll call, present vs present and voting, quorum, and GSL.
10-25 min	Run a mock roll call and open the GSL.
25-40 min	Practice 60-second GSL speeches with yields and POIs.
40-55 min	Run moderated caucus motions and speeches.
55-70 min	Run an unmoderated caucus to form blocs and draft a working paper.
70-85 min	Convert a working paper idea into a mini draft resolution and one amendment.
85-90 min	Simulate closure of debate and a quick substantive vote.

20. Quick-reference tables

20.1 Points quick reference

Point / request	Purpose	Interrupt?	Chair response
Point of Personal Privilege	Comfort, safety, audibility.	Only if urgent.	Address immediately if valid.
Point of Order	Procedural error.	Only if immediate, at Chair discretion.	Rule well taken / not well taken.
Point of Parliamentary Inquiry	Ask about procedure.	No.	Answer briefly.
Point of Information	Question to speaker.	No.	Only when speaker yields or Chair permits.
Right of Reply	Grave insult.	No; usually written.	Chair decides; no automatic right.
Appeal	Challenge Chair ruling.	No; usually written.	Follow conference appeal process.

20.2 Motions quick reference

Motion	Purpose	Second?	Debate?	Typical threshold
Set agenda	Choose topic order.	Usually yes	For/against speakers	Simple majority
Open GSL	Begin formal debate.	Usually yes	No	Simple majority or no objection
Set/change speaking time	Set GSL speech length.	Usually yes	No	Simple majority
Moderated caucus	Focused formal-ish debate.	Usually yes	No	Simple majority
Unmoderated caucus	Informal negotiation/drafting.	Usually yes	No	Simple majority
Extend caucus	Continue current caucus.	Usually yes	No	Simple majority; must be shorter than original in many conferences
Introduce draft resolution	Bring approved DR to floor.	Varies	No	Automatic or procedural vote, depending on rules
Introduce amendment	Bring approved amendment to floor.	Varies	Varies	Usually procedural to introduce; substantive to adopt if unfriendly
Table debate	Set aside current topic.	Usually yes	Often 2 for / 2 against	Often two-thirds
Resume debate	Return to tabled topic.	Usually yes	Often 2 for / 2 against	Often two-thirds
Closure of debate	Move to voting procedure.	Usually yes	Usually only speakers against	Often two-thirds
Suspend meeting	Pause until later.	Usually yes	No	Simple majority / Chair discretion
Adjourn meeting	End meeting/session.	Usually yes	No	Often high threshold / Chair discretion

20.3 Caucus comparison

Feature	Moderated caucus	Unmoderated caucus
Purpose	Focused debate on one subtopic.	Informal negotiation, bloc formation, drafting.
Motion needs	Topic, total time, individual speaking time.	Total time, sometimes purpose.
Chair role	Recognizes each speaker.	Keeps order and time, but does not run speeches.
Movement	Delegates remain seated.	Delegates may move around unless restricted.
Yields	Usually out of order.	Not applicable.
Best used for	Clarifying policy disagreements.	Writing and merging documents.

20.4 Document ladder

Stage	Status	Voteable?	Main purpose
Ideas / bloc notes	Informal.	No.	Gather solutions.
Working paper	Dais-reviewed informal document.	No, usually.	Organize proposals for debate.
Draft resolution	Formal Dais-approved text.	Yes, after introduction and closure.	Propose committee action.
Amendment	Formal change to a draft resolution.	Friendly: no; unfriendly: yes.	Improve or challenge draft text.
Resolution	Adopted draft resolution.	Already voted.	Final committee decision/recommendation.

21. Resolution writing appendix

21.1 Draft resolution skeleton

Skeleton

Committee: [Committee Name]
 Topic: [Agenda Item]
 Sponsors: [Country], [Country], [Country]
 Signatories: [Country], [Country], [Country], [Country]
 Draft Resolution 1.1

The [Committee Name],

Recalling [previous UN resolution, treaty, report, or principle],
 Recognizing [key problem or context],
 Deeply concerned by [impact on people, security, development, rights, etc.],

1. Encourages [actor] to [specific action] by [method/timeline];
2. Requests [UN body/agency] to [specific program/action], including:
 - a. [sub-action],
 - b. [sub-action],
 - c. [sub-action];
3. Recommends the creation of [mechanism] funded through [realistic source];
4. Calls upon Member States to [voluntary or mandatory action depending on mandate].

21.2 Preambulatory phrase bank

Neutral / legal	Concern / urgency	Positive / cooperative
Recalling	Alarmed by	Recognizing
Guided by	Deeply concerned by	Appreciating
Having considered	Noting with concern	Acknowledging
Bearing in mind	Aware of	Welcoming
Taking into account	Emphasizing	Affirming

21.3 Operative phrase bank

Soft / recommendatory	Programmatic	Stronger / formal
Encourages	Requests	Decides
Recommends	Calls upon	Establishes
Invites	Urges	Authorizes
Suggests	Supports	Mandates
Further encourages	Designates	Condemns

21.4 Clause quality checklist

- Actor: Who does the action?
- Action: What exactly happens?
- Mechanism: Through what body, fund, partnership, or program?
- Timeline: When or how often?
- Funding: Where does support come from?
- Monitoring: How is progress measured?
- Mandate: Does the committee have authority to recommend or do this?
- Sovereignty: Does the clause respect state consent where needed?

21.5 Sample mini draft resolution

Mini Draft Resolution 1.1 - Food Security Early Warning

Committee: Economic and Social Council
 Topic: Strengthening food security in climate-vulnerable regions
 Sponsors: Kenya, Bangladesh, Brazil
 Signatories: Ghana, Mexico, Indonesia, Norway, South Africa

The Economic and Social Council,

Recognizing the connection between climate shocks, agricultural instability, and food insecurity,
 Recalling the role of FAO and WFP in supporting national food security planning,
 Emphasizing the importance of state-led and regionally coordinated early warning systems,

1. Encourages Member States to strengthen voluntary regional early warning networks for drought, flooding, and crop failure;
2. Requests FAO, in cooperation with willing regional organizations, to provide technical assistance for climate-resilient agricultural planning;
3. Recommends the creation of emergency grain storage partnerships in high-risk regions through voluntary contributions and public-private cooperation;
4. Calls upon Member States to share non-sensitive food price and crop risk data on a quarterly basis where national law permits;
5. Encourages donor states and development banks to support smallholder farmers through training, microcredit access, and climate-resilient seeds.

22. Glossary and sources consulted

22.1 Glossary

Term	Meaning
Abstain	A choice not to vote Yes or No on a substantive matter. Usually not allowed for present and voting delegates.
Adjournment	Ending a meeting or final committee session.
Amendment	A formal change to a draft resolution.
Bloc	A group of delegations working together on shared policy or documents.
Chair / Dais / EB	Committee leadership that runs procedure and evaluates documents.
Chit	A written note used for communication, questions, or substantive input, depending on conference rules.
Closure of debate	Motion that ends debate and moves committee into voting procedure.
Draft resolution	Formal voteable proposal submitted by sponsors and signatories after Dais approval.
Formal debate	Structured debate through the GSL or recognized speaking order.
GSL	General Speakers List; the main list of speakers for formal debate.
Moderated caucus	Focused debate where Chair recognizes speakers directly.
Motion	Formal request for the committee to take procedural action.
Point	A procedural or comfort-related intervention, not a motion.
POI	Point of Information; a question to a speaker.
Present	Roll call status allowing participation and usually abstention on substantive votes.
Present and voting	Roll call status requiring Yes or No on substantive votes.
Quorum	Minimum presence required to open debate or take decisions.
Signatory	Delegation that wants a draft resolution discussed, without necessarily supporting it.
Sponsor	Delegation that authors and supports a draft resolution.
Unmoderated caucus	Informal negotiation period for bloc formation and drafting.
Working paper	Informal document that organizes ideas before a draft resolution.
Yield	Giving remaining speech time to the Chair, another delegate, or POIs.

22.2 Sources consulted

This guide was drafted as an original teaching document and checked against current public sources and common UNA-USA-style ROP handbooks. Because conference procedure varies, these sources should be treated as validation and context, not as a substitute for a conference-specific rulebook. It was prepared using ChatGPT Pro.

Source	URL	Use
UNA-USA, Model UN program page	https://unausa.org/programs/students/model-un/	Used for current UNA-USA Model UN context and educational framing.
United Nations, Guide to Model UN: Agenda, Workplan, Documents and Rules of Procedure	https://www.un.org/en/model-united-nations/agenda-workplan-documents-and-rules-procedure	Used for general UN Model UN organizer/delegate context around rules of procedure and formal/informal process.
UNA-USA Rules of Procedure Guide, common long-form ROP handbook	https://www.scribd.com/document/717279408/Unausa-Rop	Used to cross-check common rules on agenda setting, GSL, yields, points, motions, working papers, draft resolutions, amendments, and voting.

22.3 Final trainer note

The best MUN committees do not obsess over procedure for its own sake. They use procedure to create fair access, disciplined debate, serious negotiation, and written outcomes. Teach delegates the rules, then teach them when and why each rule matters.